In 2006, Marvel prepared to release its first-ever self-produced film. The company knew it had to make a splash at Comic-Con International: San Diego, the traditional launching place for sci-fi genre films. So a series of special posters and giveaways was prepared, along with an exclusive preview reel.

That film was *Iron Man*. The fans loved it—then the world loved it—and the rest is history.

The fans and viewers who attended Comic-Con that year helped make that first Iron Man film a record-breaking success. In 2012, as the cast and crew of *Iron Man 3* prepared to release the trilogy's climax, they returned to Comic-Con—presenting panels and a teaser poster that hinted at both Tony Stark's new Mark XLII capabilities and the dire situation in which he'd soon find himself.

But the expectations for *Iron Man 3* in 2013 had been redefined in light of the tremendous success of not only *Iron Man* and *Iron Man 2*, but also *Marvel's The Avengers*—one of the biggest blockbusters of all time. And a successful promotional campaign doesn't just get the word out. It teases and hints at what viewers will see without giving away the film's key dramatic moments or plot reversals before it's released. Fans want to know more, but don't want to know so much that the element of surprise is lost. Promoting *Iron Man 3* without giving too much away becomes a balancing act for everyone involved.

Iron Man 3 is a special film. It's the culmination of the company's original vision for a cinematic Marvel Universe, a bringing-to-life of a rich world of intricate character interactions and heroic-yet-flawed complex personalities. The promotional campaign had to live up to high expectations, and the artwork on the following pages shows several of the steps the designers followed to reach that point.

